

PFL-AI: the nineteen competencies

Each competency of the PCI AI Project Finance Leader —
defined, levelled, evidenced, and separated from its look-alike

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AI proposes. The professional disposes.

— Summary

The PCI AI Project Finance Leader credential publishes nineteen competencies. This document takes each one in turn and states what it is in terms of decisions, what it looks like at each of the four levels, the named artefacts that evidence it, and the common false positive — the thing that is routinely mistaken for the competency and is not it.

— About this document

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PFL-AI: the nineteen competencies

its look-alike.

In one paragraph. The PCI AI Project Finance Leader credential publishes nineteen competencies. This document takes each one in turn and states what it is in terms of decisions, what it looks like at each of the four levels, the named artefacts that evidence it, and the common false positive — the thing that is routinely mistaken for the competency and is not it. It is the working reference for anyone assembling evidence, specifying a project finance role, or assessing a claim against the PFL-AI standard.

Who this is for. Candidates for PFL-AI; heads of project finance, transaction leads and lending teams designing roles and development plans; assessors applying the standard to evidence they did not collect.

— 1. How to read this document

The nineteen competencies below are the published PFL-AI set, in the published order, unaltered. Each entry follows the structure set out in CMP-01 §3: **definition** (the decisions the competency governs), **by level** (the four-level scale defined in CMP-02 §2 and not restated here), **evidence** (named artefacts), and **the false positive**.

One scope statement first, because candidates infer more than exists. **No examination blueprint has been published for PFL-AI** — no domain weightings, no item counts [\[CONFIRM: PFL-AI examination blueprint — weightings and item counts\]](#). The competency set below is the authoritative published statement of what the credential claims; it is not a syllabus with a weighting, and it should not be read as one. Item counts for any PCI examination await a formal job-task analysis, and the definitive pass mark will be set by a modified-Angoff standard-setting study; the platform's configured mark is 65 % and scoring is criterion-referenced, not graded on a curve.

Acronyms used throughout are expanded on first appearance: special purpose vehicle (SPV), cash flow available for debt service (CFADS), debt service cover ratio (DSCR), loan life cover ratio (LLCR), project life cover ratio (PLCR), public-private partnership (PPP), environmental and social (E&S), internal rate of return (IRR), net present value (NPV), weighted average cost of capital (WACC).

— 2. Foundations and appraisal

2.1 Project finance

Definition. Financing an asset on the strength of its own cash flows, in a ring-fenced vehicle, with recourse to sponsors limited by agreement rather than by sentiment. The competency is the ability

to place a transaction correctly on the recourse spectrum and to work out who bears which risk once the structure is built.

By level. Foundation — describes the structure of a financing accurately: the SPV, the sponsors, the lenders, the principal contracts. Practitioner — works inside a live transaction, tracing how a particular risk is allocated through the contract suite and into the financing documents. Professional — decides whether a project should be financed on a limited-recourse basis at all, and identifies the risks that the structure has failed to allocate to anyone. Leader — sets a firm's or a lender's approach to structuring, and declines transactions whose risk allocation is unsound however attractive the returns.

Evidence. A structure memorandum you authored; a risk allocation matrix tracing each material risk to the party bearing it and the document that puts it there; a documented recommendation against a structure, with reasoning and outcome.

The false positive. Vocabulary. Fluency in the terminology of project finance is acquired quickly and proves nothing. The diagnostic question is the unglamorous one: which risk in this structure is currently unallocated, and who will actually pay if it happens? Structures fail at the risks nobody was assigned.

2.2 Infrastructure finance

Definition. Applying project finance to infrastructure assets specifically — the sector economics, the counterparties, the regulatory and political exposure, the revenue mechanisms (availability payment, usage or demand, regulated return) and the investor base that buys these assets at each stage of life.

By level. Foundation — distinguishes the main revenue mechanisms and what each implies for risk. Practitioner — analyses an asset within a sector they know: understands its demand drivers, regulatory regime and comparable transactions. Professional — assesses an asset in a sector or jurisdiction that is new to them by identifying what must be true for the revenue to arrive, and tests it. Leader — sets sector strategy or lending appetite, and owns the concentration risk that follows.

Evidence. A sector or asset analysis you produced, naming demand drivers and regulatory exposures; a revenue-mechanism comparison for a specific asset; a written view on a jurisdiction's regulatory risk that was tested by subsequent events.

The false positive. Sector familiarity mistaken for sector analysis. Having worked on eight roads does not mean a person can say what would make the ninth fail. The competency is analytical, not biographical.

2.3 Financial modelling

Definition. Building, auditing and using a model that represents a transaction faithfully enough to support a decision — structure, integrity, transparency of assumptions, and the discipline that lets someone else find and test any number in it. Depth in CMP-06 §6.

By level. Foundation — navigates a model, traces a calculation and updates inputs without breaking it. Practitioner — builds and maintains model sections to a defined standard: consistent formulae, no hard-coded values in calculation blocks, working checks, documented inputs. Professional — designs a model for a transaction: decides granularity, timing convention, circularity treatment and scenario architecture; audits others' models and finds the errors that matter; states

the model's limitations alongside its output. Leader — sets modelling standards, decides what model risk the organisation accepts, and requires independent review where reliance is material.

Evidence. A model you built, with its documentation, check sheet and assumption log; a model audit report you wrote, with findings and materiality; a scenario architecture you designed; a modelling standard in use in your organisation with your authorship.

The false positive. Speed and formula complexity. A rapidly built model with elaborate formulae and no checks is a liability, and the more impressive it looks the longer the error survives. The competency is visible in the checks, the assumption log and the auditability, which is exactly the part that takes the time.

2.4 Investment appraisal

Definition. Deciding whether a project is worth doing, using discounted cash flow and its companions, with the discount rate, the cash flow definition and the treatment of tax and inflation chosen deliberately and stated. Includes knowing which metric answers which question and where each one misleads.

By level. Foundation — computes net present value (NPV), internal rate of return (IRR) and payback correctly from a given cash flow. Practitioner — prepares an appraisal to procedure, applies the organisation's discount rate, and presents results with sensitivities. Professional — decides the appraisal basis: which cash flows are relevant, whose returns are being measured (project or equity), the discount rate and its justification, and the consistent treatment of inflation and tax. Identifies where IRR is a misleading answer — non-conventional cash flows, mutually exclusive projects of different scale or life — and says so. Leader — sets the appraisal standard and hurdle-rate policy, and owns the consequence of the incentives that policy creates.

Evidence. An appraisal you authored stating the cash flow definition, discount rate basis and inflation/tax convention; a sensitivity and breakeven analysis naming the variables the decision turns on; a documented case where you rejected a metric as unsuitable and explained what to use instead.

The false positive. Producing the metrics. The arithmetic is not the competency; the definition of what is being discounted, at what rate, and whose return it represents is the competency. An appraisal whose discount rate is "the one we always use" has not been appraised.

2.5 Capital structure

Definition. Deciding the shape of the funding — how much debt against equity, the tenor and amortisation profile relative to the asset's cash generation, the sequencing of drawdowns, and the consequences of the shape for resilience and for returns.

By level. Foundation — reads a sources-and-uses statement and a funding profile accurately. Practitioner — models alternative gearing and amortisation profiles and reports their effects on returns and cover ratios. Professional — recommends a structure for a specific transaction, stating the trade-off between equity return and the project's ability to survive a downside, and the point at which additional leverage stops being efficient. Leader — sets structuring policy, and decides the leverage the organisation will not exceed regardless of what a market will bear.

Evidence. A structuring paper comparing profiles with the reasoning for the recommendation; a downside resilience analysis at alternative gearing levels; a documented recommendation to reduce leverage against commercial pressure to increase it.

The false positive. Optimisation to a target return. Solving for the gearing that hits an equity return is an exercise in inversion. The competency is the judgement about what the structure does when revenue disappoints, which is the question the model was not asked.

2.6 Debt and equity

Definition. The instruments themselves: senior and subordinated debt, mezzanine, sponsor equity and shareholder loans, bonds and private placements, hedging arrangements — their terms, their ranking, their protections, and the behaviour of their holders when the project underperforms.

By level. Foundation — identifies instruments and their ranking in a capital stack. Practitioner — works with term sheets and facility documentation, tracks conditions and covenants, and models drawdown, interest and repayment mechanics correctly. Professional — negotiates or advises on terms with a view to how they will operate in a downside: which covenant bites first, what the cure rights are, and how the intercreditor arrangement behaves when parties disagree. Leader — sets the terms the organisation requires and concedes, and owns the portfolio consequence of that position.

Evidence. A term sheet you negotiated or reviewed with your annotations and rationale; a covenant analysis showing which test binds under stress; a waiver or restructuring you worked on, with the reasoning; hedging documentation and its modelled effect.

The false positive. Documentation familiarity. Knowing where a provision sits is administration. The competency is anticipating the instrument's behaviour under stress — and the honest test is whether the person has ever seen, or modelled, what happens when the covenant is breached.

— 3. Bankability, structures and the transaction

3.1 Project bankability

Definition. The composite judgement about whether lenders will fund a project on acceptable terms: revenue certainty, contract quality, counterparty strength, risk allocation, sponsor capability, and the resilience of cover under downside cases. Bankability is a conclusion assembled from the other competencies, not a measure in itself.

By level. Foundation — lists the factors lenders assess. Practitioner — assembles a bankability assessment against a checklist and identifies gaps in the documentation. Professional — forms and defends a view on whether a project is bankable, names the two or three issues that will decide it, and proposes the specific structural changes that would fix them. Leader — sets the institution's bankability standard and declines transactions that meet the checklist but fail the judgement.

Evidence. A bankability assessment you authored, with the issues ranked and the remedies proposed; a gap-closure plan that was implemented; a credit paper you wrote, and the outcome; a project you advised against, with the reasons recorded.

The false positive. Checklist completion. A complete checklist tells you the documents exist. The competency is knowing which two items on the list will actually determine the outcome, and being right often enough to be worth asking.

3.2 DSCR, LLCR and PLCR

Definition. The cover ratios by which lenders measure protection — the debt service cover ratio (DSCR), being cash flow available for debt service (CFADS) over scheduled debt service in the same period; the loan life cover ratio (LLCR), being the present value of CFADS over the loan's remaining life against debt outstanding; and the project life cover ratio (PLCR), the same construction over the project's full remaining life. The competency includes knowing what each ratio protects against and how each is manipulated.

By level. Foundation — calculates each ratio correctly and states its definition, including what is and is not in CFADS. Practitioner — models the ratios across a transaction's life, identifies the binding period, and reconciles ratio movements to their drivers. Professional — decides what the lock-up and default levels should be for a given risk profile, defines CFADS precisely in the documentation, and detects definitional games — items moved above or below the CFADS line, reserve accounts flattering a period, a discount rate choice inflating LLCR. Leader — sets minimum cover standards by asset class and owns the exceptions.

Evidence. A ratio analysis identifying the binding period and its driver; a negotiated CFADS definition and your rationale; a documented challenge to a ratio presentation you judged misleading; a downside case showing where cover is lost and what happens next.

The false positive. Calculation. The ratio is arithmetic once CFADS is defined; the competency is in the definition, the base case behind it and the downside at which it fails. A person who can produce the ratio but cannot say what would have to happen for it to breach has the arithmetic, not the competency.

3.3 PPPs and concessions

Definition. Structures in which a public authority contracts a private party to finance, build and operate an asset over a long term — the payment mechanism, the risk transfer intended and the risk transfer achieved, the performance and deduction regime, change and termination provisions, and handback.

By level. Foundation — describes the main PPP and concession models and how each is paid. Practitioner — works within a concession: models the payment mechanism including deductions, tracks performance obligations, and applies change provisions. Professional — assesses whether a proposed risk transfer is real — whether the private party can price and manage the risk it is being given — and identifies the provisions that will cause disputes in year eight. Advises on the termination and handback regime as a financeable proposition. Leader — sets policy on which concession structures the organisation will accept, and owns long-tenor political and regulatory exposure.

Evidence. A payment-mechanism model with the deduction regime implemented; an analysis of risk transfer versus risk pricing for a specific project; commentary on termination compensation and its effect on financeability; a lessons-learned note from an operating concession.

The false positive. Model familiarity. Knowing the taxonomy of PPP models is introductory material. The competency shows in the payment mechanism — the one document that decides whether the asset earns — and in whether the person has ever traced a deduction through to its cash effect.

3.4 Project contracts

Definition. The contract suite that makes the cash flows credible: the construction contract, the operations and maintenance agreement, the offtake or revenue agreement, supply agreements, and the interfaces between them. The competency is reading them as a financing package rather than as separate documents, and finding the gaps between them.

By level. Foundation — identifies the principal contracts and their commercial purpose. Practitioner — extracts and models the financial terms: liquidated damages, caps, indexation, payment terms, availability regimes. Professional — identifies mismatches across the suite — a liability cap below the loss it is meant to cover, an indexation basis that differs between revenue and cost, a force majeure definition that leaves relief on one side of a back-to-back — and negotiates them closed. Leader — sets the contractual conditions the organisation requires before it will lend or invest.

Evidence. A contract review memorandum identifying financial exposures with clause references; a back-to-back gap analysis; a negotiated change that closed a mismatch you found; a model faithfully implementing contractual mechanics.

The false positive. Legal review. Lawyers assess enforceability; this competency assesses financial consequence. The distinguishing question is whether the person can say what a clause is worth in cash and in which scenario it pays.

3.5 Financial close

Definition. Getting a transaction from agreed terms to funded: the conditions precedent, the diligence workstreams and their sequencing, document negotiation, the closing model and its agreement between parties, and the choreography of signing and first drawdown.

By level. Foundation — tracks conditions precedent and maintains the checklist accurately. Practitioner — runs a workstream to close: manages diligence inputs, resolves routine conditions, and maintains the closing model version control. Professional — runs or leads a close: sequences the critical path of the transaction, decides which conditions can be waived or deferred and on what terms, and holds the base-case model agreed across parties. Leader — decides whether a transaction is ready to close, and stops one that is not despite the cost of delay.

Evidence. A conditions-precedent tracker you owned through to satisfaction; a closing checklist and timetable you built; a documented decision to defer or waive a condition, with the mitigation; an agreed final base-case model with version control and sign-off.

The false positive. Presence at closings. Attending a completed transaction is exposure. The competency is in the critical path — knowing which condition would have delayed close and what was done about it two weeks earlier.

3.6 Commercial and financial risk

Definition. Identifying, allocating, mitigating and pricing the risks that determine whether the cash flows arrive: construction cost and delay, revenue and demand, counterparty credit, interest rate, inflation, currency, refinancing, regulatory and political risk. The competency is the connection between identifying a risk and doing something with it in the structure, the contracts or the price.

By level. Foundation — identifies the main risk categories and where each is usually allocated. Practitioner — runs risk analysis for a transaction: builds sensitivities and downside cases,

quantifies exposures, and tracks mitigation into the documentation. Professional — decides the risk case: which scenarios must be survived and which are tolerable, how correlated risks are treated together, and where the residual sits after all mitigation. Says what the project cannot survive. Leader — sets the institution's risk appetite for the asset class and owns the aggregate position.

Evidence. A downside and stress-case suite with the reasoning for each case; a risk allocation matrix with the mitigation and residual named; a decision to price or decline a specific risk; a case where your stress case was later approximated by events.

The false positive. Sensitivity tables. Flexing one variable at a time produces a grid, not a risk view; real downsides arrive correlated, and the single-variable table is the one presentation that guarantees they will not be seen. The competency is the combined case, and the willingness to name the scenario in which the project fails.

3.7 Sustainable finance

Definition. Financing structures and obligations tied to environmental and social outcomes: use-of-proceeds instruments and sustainability-linked pricing, lender E&S requirements and the diligence and monitoring they require, transition and physical climate risk in the cash flows, and disclosure obligations that vary by market.

By level. Foundation — describes the main instrument types and the difference between use-of-proceeds and performance-linked structures. Practitioner — implements the requirements: assembles E&S diligence inputs, models margin adjustments tied to performance indicators, and maintains reporting obligations. Professional — designs the sustainability provisions so that they are measurable and meaningful: selects indicators that are material and auditable, sets thresholds that require actual change, and resists structures whose targets would be met by ordinary course of business. Assesses E&S risk against recognised lender frameworks. Leader — sets the organisation's position, including declining transactions that are compliant and not credible.

Evidence. A sustainability-linked mechanism you specified, with indicator definitions and thresholds; an E&S diligence scope and its findings; a climate risk analysis integrated into cash flow rather than appended; a documented rejection of a proposed indicator as unmeasurable or immaterial.

The false positive. Labelling. An instrument with a sustainability label, a framework document and a second-party opinion may involve no change in behaviour whatsoever. The competency is in indicator design and materiality — whether meeting the target requires the borrower to do something they would not otherwise have done.

3.8 Islamic project finance

Definition. Structuring project financing consistent with Islamic finance principles — asset-backed or asset-based structures such as ijara (lease), istisna'a (construction and manufacture), murabaha (cost-plus sale), wakala (agency) and sukuk issuance — and running them alongside conventional tranches where a transaction has both. The competency includes the governance interface: what Shariah approval requires and how it constrains structuring.

By level. Foundation — describes the principal structures and how each generates a return without interest. Practitioner — works within an Islamic tranche: models its payment mechanics, tracks its documentation and maintains its distinctions from a conventional tranche. Professional — structures the Islamic element of a transaction, resolves intercreditor and ranking issues between Islamic and conventional tranches, and manages the approval process without

compromising the financing's commercial logic. Leader — sets the institution's approach and its relationships with Shariah governance bodies.

Evidence. An Islamic tranche you structured or modelled, with its mechanics documented; an intercreditor analysis across Islamic and conventional tranches; a structuring paper responding to Shariah board observations; a sukuk structure diagram you produced.

The false positive. Terminology substitution. Treating an Islamic structure as a conventional loan with different labels misses the asset ownership, risk-sharing and permissibility constraints that determine what may be done, and produces structures that fail at approval. The competency requires understanding why the structure is shaped as it is, not only that it is.

— 4. The data, digital and AI group

Five competencies, forming the same chain described in CMP-08: analysis produces a proposal, the workflow decides where it enters, governance constrains it, and a named human validates and owns it.

4.1 AI-enabled financial modelling

Definition. Using AI assistance within modelling work — generating or reviewing formulae, checking structure, drafting documentation, interrogating a model in natural language, testing for errors — with a clear position on what the model's integrity depends on and what may never be delegated.

By level. Foundation — uses approved assistance for defined tasks and checks output before use. Practitioner — incorporates assistance into modelling routines: error scanning, documentation drafting, consistency checking, with the results verified against the model itself. Professional — decides where assistance is admitted and where it is excluded — typically excluding the definition of the transaction logic, which is the part that has to be reasoned — and specifies the check that stands between assisted output and reliance. Leader — sets the standard for AI-assisted modelling, including disclosure and model-risk treatment, and owns the consequences.

Evidence. A documented workflow showing assisted steps and their checks; an error-detection routine and what it found; a documented decision on which modelling tasks are not delegated; a model with an assistance disclosure and validation record.

The false positive. Output volume. Producing model sections quickly with assistance and no verification step increases model risk with excellent presentation. The competency is the check design and the exclusions.

4.2 Predictive cash-flow analysis

Definition. Using data and quantitative technique to say something about future cash generation — demand or usage forecasting, cost and revenue trend analysis, probabilistic distributions of CFADS, early-warning indicators — and knowing when a data-driven forecast is inadmissible because the data does not carry the question.

By level. Foundation — interprets a probabilistic output correctly, including its confidence and its base. Practitioner — builds and runs the analysis, prepares data, tests fit, and reports central case with dispersion. Professional — chooses the technique for the question, back-tests against held-out periods, reports their own model's error and bias, and states where the analysis fails — typically

for assets without a comparable history, or where regulatory change breaks the series. Leader — sets what the organisation will forecast quantitatively and owns the data investment that makes it possible.

Evidence. An analysis with its data basis, validation and error characteristics stated; a back-test of your own forecasts; a documented refusal to produce a quantitative forecast where the data would not support it, and the alternative offered.

The false positive. Fitting the past. High explanatory power over history says nothing about predictive power, and a model with an impressive fit is the easiest thing in this discipline to sell to a committee. The competency shows in the out-of-sample test.

4.3 Digital due diligence

Definition. Using data and automated tooling to run diligence better — completeness checking across data rooms, contract term extraction and comparison, anomaly detection in historical financials, model audit assistance — and knowing which diligence conclusions may never rest on automated extraction alone.

By level. Foundation — uses the tooling as directed and verifies extracted items against source. Practitioner — runs digital diligence workstreams, reconciles extracted data to primary documents, and maintains an audit trail from finding to source. Professional — designs the diligence approach: what is automated, what sampling verifies the automation, and which findings require a human reading of the whole document because the meaning is in the interaction between clauses. Leader — sets diligence standards and owns the risk that automation created a false sense of completeness.

Evidence. A diligence plan distinguishing automated from manual scope with sampling rates; a reconciliation of extracted terms to source documents with the error rate found; a finding that automated extraction missed, and the process change that followed.

The false positive. Coverage claims. "All 400 contracts were reviewed" describes a process that ran, not a conclusion that holds. The competency is in the verification design — the sample that proves the extraction was right, and the honesty about what the sample can and cannot support.

4.4 Responsible AI

Definition. Governing AI use across the transaction lifecycle: what data may be entered into which tool, particularly counterparty and confidential deal information; where AI-derived analysis must be disclosed to a credit committee or investor; how bias is considered where models touch counterparty assessment; and which uses are prohibited.

By level. Foundation — follows the policy, especially on confidential data. Practitioner — applies it in live transactions, discloses assistance where required, and escalates outputs that cannot be explained. Professional — sets the position for a transaction or team: data handling, disclosure convention, explainability as a precondition of reliance, and named prohibitions. Leader — owns the governance framework, its procurement criteria and its incident handling, and prohibits uses the organisation would find profitable.

Evidence. A transaction-level AI use position you authored; a disclosure convention adopted in credit or investment papers; a documented prohibition and its rationale; an incident review with the resulting control change.

The false positive. Policy possession. A policy nobody has tested against a real decision is a document. The evidence is a decision that cost something.

4.5 Human validation

Definition. Checking AI-derived or automated output before it is relied upon, and owning it as your own work — designing a check capable of catching the error that matters, performing it, recording it, and being answerable for what you signed. In a financing context the outputs at issue are model results, extracted contract terms, forecast cash flows and drafted analysis.

By level. Foundation — performs the prescribed check and escalates failures. Practitioner — validates against independent sources within their scope and records what was checked and found. Professional — designs validation per output type: the independent source, the sample, the tolerance, and the errors the check would not catch. Rejects output that cannot be validated in the time available. Leader — sets the validation standard so it cannot be discharged by signature, and owns validated failures as failures of the standard.

Evidence. A validation protocol naming source and tolerance per output type; signed validation records including findings that stopped something; a rejection of unvalidatable output and its replacement; a revised check following a miss.

The false positive. The confirmation tick. The house position is that AI proposes and the professional disposes — which is only true where the disposal is an independent check by someone who could have caught the error and would have said so.

— 5. Where the boundaries actually lie

Project finance and infrastructure finance. The first is a financing technique and a risk-allocation discipline; the second applies it to a specific asset class with its own economics and counterparties.

Capital structure and debt and equity. Structure is the shape — how much, over what tenor, in what sequence. Debt and equity are the instruments that implement the shape and behave in particular ways when things go wrong.

Investment appraisal and financial modelling. Appraisal is the decision and its basis; the model is the instrument. A flawless model can implement an incoherent appraisal basis, and usually does so invisibly.

Bankability and the cover ratios. The ratios are measures within the judgement. A project can present strong ratios in a base case that no lender believes, and the competency is knowing that the base case is the question.

PPPs and project contracts. A PPP or concession is an ownership and payment structure; project contracts are the suite implementing it. The payment mechanism sits at the join and is where most value is won or lost.

— 6. How this goes wrong

All nineteen are claimed at leader level. No individual has that spread; Islamic project finance and sustainable finance in particular are specialisms that many strong practitioners have never

touched. Say so. An honest foundation-level statement costs nothing and buys credibility for the claims that matter.

Modelling evidence is a model file with no reasoning. A workbook demonstrates that a workbook exists. Evidence is the check sheet, the assumption log, the audit findings and the version history.

Cover-ratio competence is evidenced by a formula. The formula is public. Evidence is a negotiated CFADS definition, a binding-period analysis, or a challenge to a presentation that flattered a period.

Transaction experience substitutes for competence. "Worked on twelve closings" is a duration claim. Which condition would have delayed close, and what did you do about it before it did?

The false positive is the candidate's whole portfolio. Checklist bankability assessments, sensitivity tables in place of stress cases, extraction coverage in place of verification. Each of these is real work, performed at practitioner level, presented as professional-level judgement — and an assessor will place it correctly, so the candidate loses the credit they would have received for claiming it accurately.

Islamic finance structures are described as conventional finance with different names. This is the single most common error in the set, and it is visible immediately to anyone who works in the field.

Sustainability provisions are evidenced by the presence of a label. Name the indicator, its definition, its threshold and what the borrower had to change.

— 7. Checklist

For a candidate assembling evidence, or an assessor reviewing it:

- [] Have all nineteen competencies been addressed, including honest foundation-level statements?
- [] Does each have a **dated artefact** with an identifiable personal contribution?
- [] For modelling: is there a check sheet, an assumption log and an audit trail — not only a model?
- [] For appraisal: is the cash flow definition, discount rate basis and inflation/tax convention stated?
- [] For cover ratios: is there a CFADS definition, a binding period, and a downside at which cover fails?
- [] For bankability: are the two or three deciding issues named, or only a checklist?
- [] For risk: are there combined stress cases, not single-variable sensitivities?
- [] For the AI competencies: is the evidence a **decision** — where output enters, what check stands between it and reliance, what was excluded?
- [] Is human validation evidenced by a protocol and findings rather than a signature?
- [] Is every artefact dated, with anything older than three years flagged as historical?

— Related

- [CMP-01 – The PCI competency framework – overview](#) — what the set is for and how each entry is structured
- [CMP-02 – Competency levels and how they are evidenced](#) — the four-level scale used throughout
- [CMP-06 – Cost and commercial competencies in depth](#) — the commercial cluster shared across credentials
- [CMP-08 – Data, digital and AI competencies in depth](#) — the five-competency chain from analysis to validation
- [CMP-10 – Assessing competence – evidence, rubrics and moderation](#) — how these claims are tested
- [CER-02 – The credential suite: PCL-AI, PFL-AI, PML-AI](#) — how the three credentials differ and how to choose

— Sources and standards

- PCI platform certification catalogue ([backend/Data/MultiCert.cs](#)), verified August 2026 — the PFL-AI seeded competency set, nineteen items, reproduced here in the published order and wording.
- [docs/books/pfl-ai/COMPETENCY_MAP.md](#) — the PFL-AI competency map, which records that all nineteen published competencies are covered and that no examination blueprint exists.
- Lender environmental and social frameworks in common use in project finance, referenced generically in §3.7 and described in our own words; no framework text is reproduced and no endorsement is implied.

— Status and version

Founding-stage document · Version 1.0 — effective date to be confirmed · Reviewed under PCI governance. PCI makes no claims of accreditation or recognition beyond what is true today.